ITSM Service Desk: Results and Next Steps

Critical tickets caught	Alerts per day	Tickets reassigned	Incidents expected next 12 months
58.3%	5.2	40.7%	75K

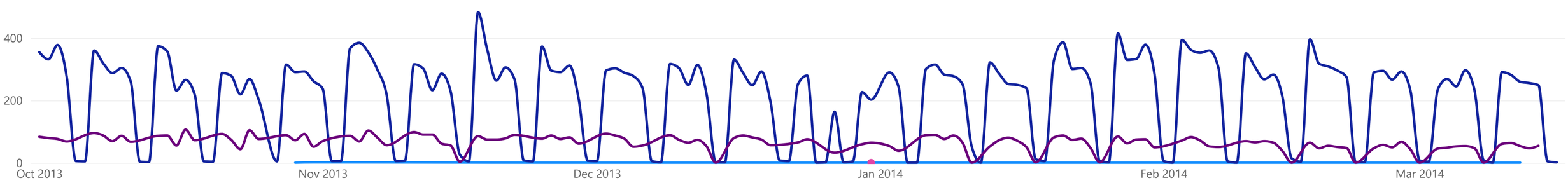
No	Objective	Result	Business value	Next step	Status
1	Spot critical tickets early	Catches 58% of P1/P2 tickets by flagging only 2.2% of tickets (about 5 alerts a day)	Critical tickets get attention sooner: 83 caught vs 62 for a simple rule at the same alert volume	Pilot a daily alert list with the service desk	Ready for pilot
2	Plan ticket volumes	About 18,500-19,100 incidents a quarter; about 75,000 in the next 12 months	Baseline for staffing and capacity planning	Refresh monthly; validate with 2-3 years of data	Planning estimate
3	Tag tickets, cut reassignments	41% of tickets are reassigned; priority tagger is right for 77% of tickets	Each hand-off adds delay: median 2.5 hours with none, 244 hours with 5 or more	Pilot priority suggestions; get the department field	Priority ready; department blocked
4	Anticipate changes and failures	Watchlist finds change-linked tickets at 20x chance; 89% of hardware faults recognised	Review risky assets early; route hardware faults directly	Weekly watchlist review; pilot hardware routing	Ready; misconfiguration blocked

Priority ▲	Improvement	Benefit	Needs
Quick win	Agree the daily alert volume with the service desk	Alerts match what the desk can handle	One workshop
Quick win	Confirm when six ticket fields are filled in	Up to 79 critical tickets caught instead of 67	Process owner confirmation
Quick win	Pilot hardware routing	71% of hardware faults could go straight to the hardware team	ServiceNow routing rule
High	Add a department or assignment-group field	Enables department tagging and fewer reassignments	Data owner (requested)
High	Extend the history to 2-3 years	Validated forecasts with yearly seasonality	Larger data extract
Medium	Add CMDB asset relationships	Enables misconfiguration prediction	CMDB access
Medium	Monitor and retrain models monthly	Catches drift: critical-ticket rate already fell from 2.1% to about 1.2%	Monthly refresh
Medium	Score tickets live in ServiceNow	Real-time alerts at ticket creation	API and integration
Later	Use ticket descriptions (NLP)	Better priority, department and fault-type suggestions	Description field

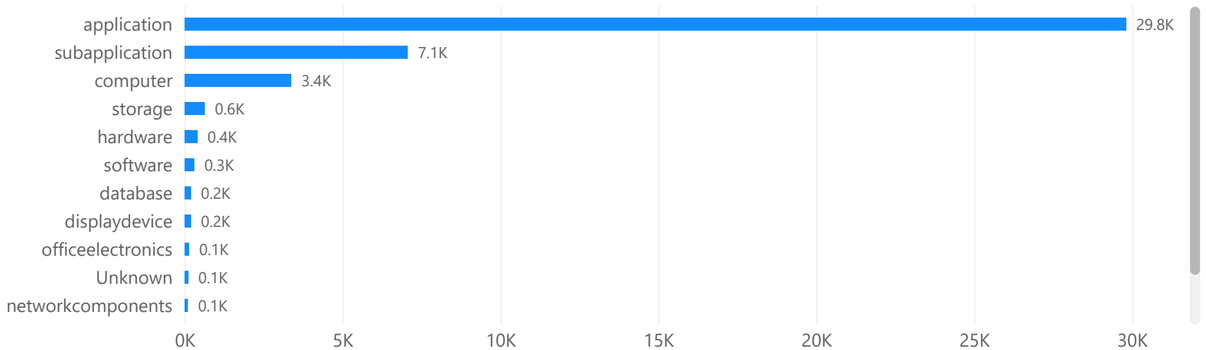
Ticket Overview (1 Oct 2013 – 16 Mar 2014)

Tickets	Critical tickets (P1/P2)	Critical ticket rate	Tickets reassigned
42K	656	1.6%	40.7%

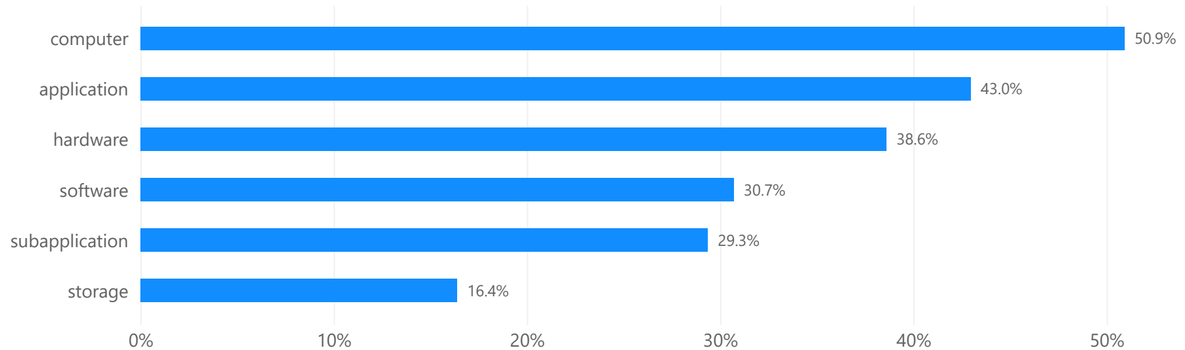
Daily tickets by category



Tickets by asset type

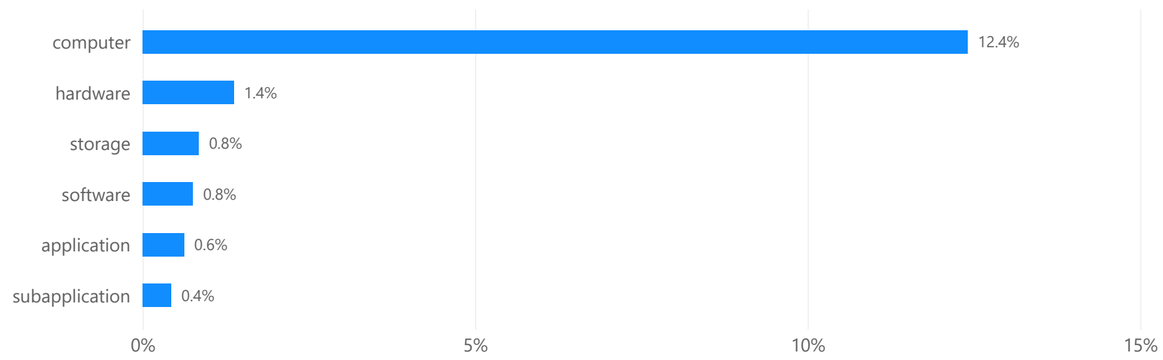


Share of tickets reassigned, by asset type



Where Critical (P1/P2) Tickets Come From

Critical ticket rate by asset type (6 largest)



Key insights

- Computer tickets are about 12% critical, against under 2% for every other asset type.
- Critical tickets peak between 8 and 11 am on weekdays, highest at 9 am.
- Monday has the most critical tickets (163); weekends have only 29 of 656.
- Staff the alert review for weekday mornings.

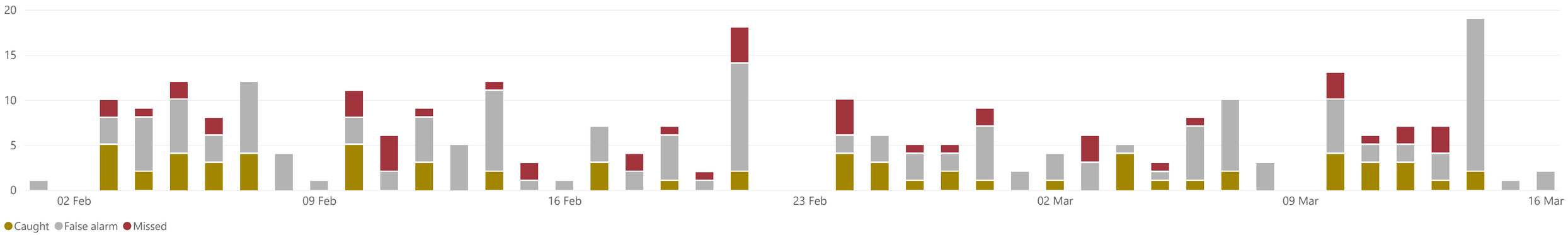
Critical tickets by weekday and hour

Weekday	0	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	21	22	23	**Total**
Monday			1	1	7	20	26	15	13	15	19	17	9	15	4	1					**163**
Tuesday		1	2	1	4	11	22	12	13	9	13	12	9	6		4	2				**121**
Wednesday			1	2	5	11	14	13	10	13	7	5	6	6	4	1					**98**
Thursday	1	1	2	1	1	5	20	14	15	8	7	7	6	15	5	2	1	1	2	1	**115**
Friday				2	5	6	17	11	23	9	8	21	11	11	3	2	1				**130**
Saturday				1		1	2	5	3	2		1				1					**16**
Sunday		1	1	2			1	1	1	1	1			1		2	1				**13**
Total	**1**	**3**	**7**	**10**	**22**	**54**	**102**	**71**	**78**	**57**	**55**	**63**	**41**	**54**	**16**	**13**	**5**	**1**	**2**	**1**	**656**

Critical Ticket Alerts: Test Period (1 Feb – 16 Mar 2014)

Critical tickets caught	Critical tickets missed	False Alarms	Share of critical tickets caught	Alerts per day
67	48	158	58.3%	5.2

Daily alerts: caught, missed and false alarms



Ticket Volume Forecast: Next 12 Months (Apr 2014 – Mar 2015)

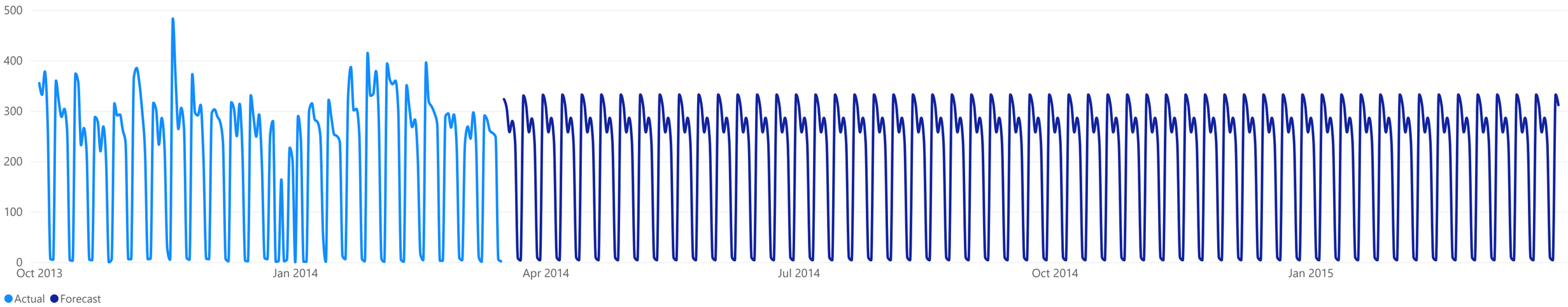
Incidents expected (12 months)
75K

All tickets expected (12 months)
93K

Series

- ○ All tickets
- ◉ Incidents

Daily tickets: actual (Oct–Mar) and forecast (to Mar 2015)



Series	Quarter	Forecast	Low (P10)	High (P90)
All tickets	Q2 2014	23,181	21,322	25,002
Incidents	Q2 2014	18,713	17,189	20,271
All tickets	Q3 2014	23,569	21,530	25,370
Incidents	Q3 2014	19,025	17,374	20,442
All tickets	Q4 2014	23,506	21,664	25,497
Incidents	Q4 2014	18,971	17,412	20,590
All tickets	Q1 2015	22,859	20,621	24,701
Incidents	Q1 2015	18,455	16,974	19,782

Series	Forecast	Low (P10)	High (P90)
All tickets	93,115	87,159	98,364
Incidents	75,164	70,908	79,407

Planning estimate based on 5.5 months of history. The range shows the 10th to 90th percentile of 500 simulated outcomes.